

The following is a faithful transcription of the typewritten original by the Servant of God, Father Solanus Casey, O.F.M. Cap.

TRIP ANNOUNCED TO "THE BLUFF"

Returning from the Bowers, between 2 and 3 P.M., what seemed to the writer a happy feature of the day's program, was proposed. We were to go to "The Bluff". To him, that seemed to mean self-understoodly, "and to Trimbelle", and so it came.

Fortunately, we took the old wagon road, rather than going a half mile north of the Elsworth Highway, or down to that, following the course of the "Father of Waters". We were beginning to think we had made a mistake in not taking the latter for the 13 mile down-the-river trip, when, turning on a fairly trod road to the right, a neat little white house loomed through the trees (small bushes at my visit in 1878) and Fr. Maurice exclaimed "Aunt Mary's old house!" "Sure enough" responded his neighbor. Fr. Edward got out and inquired how to reach the River Road down to Diamond Bluff. Fr. S. also went to the door, wishing to look in at least where nine and fifty years before he had spent happy days. Incidentally, it was during that visit of two weeks that he attended a court case in Prescott and took Judge Ross' chair while court was in session, hardly appreciating at that time why the court seemed amused. The late Judge Smith of Superior represented one side as opposed to a clever young lawyer named Wilson. However, we just waited until the senior judge returned before proceeding.....Ha! Ha!

A modest little girl of about fifteen directed us to follow the main road until we came to a Highway "E", which would bring us right down to the River Road. Off we went, high speed, past Toohey's old place, and O'Brien's and Donovan's etc. Some of them (old places) still stand. Some have disappeared. Coming down the old sand hill to Big River Bottoms, we forgot our instructions and followed the road down that old river bed. The river itself is a thing of past history. We only made about a half-mile when we found that instead of leading us to the River, our self-chosen road led us zig-zag up another hill--scenery worth while--and over a beautiful plateau-like section, till coming down to another cross-road, marked "E" we felt at ease again, knowing that now we'd reach the Bluff. Though no remark was made about it at the time, the beautiful valley down which said Highway "E" runs, is none other than what we used to know as "Manion's Ravine". I knew we had to come to that before we'd reach the Bluff.

Well, we did reach the town at last, if it could any longer be called a town. We left the highway, crossed the railroad,